

Vatican City



Area 0.17 sq miles (0.44 sq km)

Population 800

Capital Vatican City

Currency Euro

Official languages Italian and Latin

Life expectancy 80 years



Vatican City is the smallest independent nation in the world. It lies within a walled enclave in the heart of Italy's capital, Rome. It is the headquarters of the Roman Catholic Church, led by the Pope. As spiritual leader of the Roman Catholics, he has supreme powers and usually holds office until he dies. (In 2013, however, Pope Benedict XVI announced his retirement at the age of 85.)



▲ THE PIETÀ

Housed in St. Peter's Basilica in Vatican City, the Pietà by Michelangelo shows the Virgin Mary with Jesus's body after the Crucifixion.

Andorra



Area 181 sq miles

(468 sq km)

Population 85,100

Capital Andorra la Vella

Currency Euro

Official language Catalan

Life expectancy 84 years



Andorra is a tiny, landlocked country between France and Spain, lying high in the Pyrenees Mountains. It is known as a principality because the state is headed by two coprinces—the Bishop of Urgell and the President of France. Andorra's spectacular scenery and mountain climate have made tourism—especially skiing—its main source of income.

